

Ziao Yang

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Internship Availability: Fall 2026 preferred; flexible through Spring 2027.

EDUCATION

Brandeis University

Ph.D. Candidate in Computer Science

Advisor: Professor Hongfu Liu

Waltham, MA

09/2023 - 05/2027 (Expected)

Sun Yat-Sen University

B.Eng. in Computer Science and Technology

Guangzhou, China

09/2018 - 06/2022

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Large Language Models: Data Curation for Pre-Training and Post-Training, Reinforcement Learning and LLM Evaluation

Data-Centric Learning: Detrimental Sample Identification, Data Valuation, and Data-Efficient Training

RESEARCH & INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Adobe Research

Research Scientist Intern, Mentor: Dr. Vlad Morariu

Seattle, WA

05/2026 - Present

Researched methods to reduce HTML generation latency in an Adobe product while preserving output quality.

- Developed and evaluated model distillation and parallel generation methods to improve the latency-quality trade-off.
- Built an end-to-end experimentation pipeline from data generation with a 480B teacher to training, serving, and product evaluation of 8B student models.

Google Tunix Research Collaboration

Academic Research Collaborator

Remote

09/2025 - 05/2026

Researched data-centric post-training using Google Tunix on TPUs.

- Developed self-influence and outlier-based methods to filter low-signal samples in GRPO and DPO.
- Implemented DeepScaleR math-reasoning post-training and AIME 2024 evaluation on multi-host TPUs.

Adobe

Machine Learning Engineer Intern, Mentor: Dr. Lei Zhang

San Jose, CA

05/2025 - 08/2025

Developed controllable headline and email generation for Adobe GenStudio for Performance Marketing, supporting enterprise marketing workflows.

- Improved offline quality through multi-persona generation and evaluation.
- Trained a reward model and applied PPO for brand-aligned generation.

Y Combinator China

Intern, Mentor: Dr. Qi Lu

Beijing, China

03/2023 - 07/2023

Conducted AI industry research and startup scouting, translating technical and market trends into strategic insights for leadership.

- Prepared presentations and financing materials for Dr. Qi Lu, including “My Foundation Model Worldview.”
- Scouted emerging AI startups and synthesized insights from discussions with scientists at leading AI labs.

International Digital Economy Academy (IDEA)

Research Intern, Mentor: Dr. Jiaxing Zhang

Shenzhen, China

03/2022 - 07/2022

Contributed to early foundation model pre-training at IDEA, focusing on large-scale supervised data construction and multi-task classification.

- Built supervised pre-training datasets containing 27 million examples for multi-task classification.
- Pre-trained BERT and GPT models with MAML and Reptile across multiple classification tasks.

SKILLS

Python, PyTorch, JAX, Tunix, DeepSpeed, vLLM, SGLang, distributed multi-GPU and multi-host TPU training

PUBLICATIONS	Ziao Yang , Han Yue, Jian Chen, and Hongfu Liu. “Revisit, Extend, and Enhance Hessian-Free Influence Functions.” <i>Transactions on Machine Learning Research (TMLR)</i> , 2026.	
	Ziao Yang , Zizhang Chen, Lei Zhang, and Hongfu Liu. “Recontextualizing Famous Quotes for Brand Slogan Generation.” <i>Submitted to EMNLP</i> , 2026.	
	Ziao Yang , Longbo Huang, and Hongfu Liu. “Layer-Aware Influence for Online Data Valuation Estimation.” <i>Submitted to TPAMI</i> , 2026.	
	Ziao Yang , Han Yue, Jian Chen, and Hongfu Liu. “On the Inflation of KNN-Shapley Value.” <i>Submitted to DMLR</i> , 2026.	
	Yinan Shen, Ziao Yang , and Hongfu Liu. “Validation-Induced Shapley Shifts: How Validation Structure Distorts Data Valuation.” <i>arXiv preprint arXiv:2607.03675</i> , 2026.	
HONORS & AWARDS	Ziao Yang , Xiangrui Yang, and Qifeng Lin. “TCTN: A 3D-Temporal Convolutional Transformer Network for Spatiotemporal Predictive Learning.” <i>arXiv preprint arXiv:2112.01085v1</i> , 2021.	
	Ziao Yang , Xiangrui Yang, and Qifeng Lin. “PTCT: Patches with 3D-Temporal Convolutional Transformer Network for Precipitation Nowcasting.” <i>arXiv preprint arXiv:2112.01085v2</i> , 2021.	
	Tianchi Big Data Competition - AI Helps Weather Forecast (Top 1%) <i>Alibaba Group</i>	2022
	National Level of College Student Innovation Competition (Top 1) <i>Sun Yat-Sen University</i>	2022
	TCTN Official Implementation with 100+ stars on GitHub	2022
PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES	Reviewer	
	Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)	2024 - Present
	International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)	2024 - Present
	International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)	2024 - Present